

# Philip Brocoun

## Engineering Manager

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**Anthropic Claude Certified Architect**

### Profile Details

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Hello hiring manager! I'm Philip, and I began my career developing with Ruby on Rails at a startup in NYC in 2007. I have 18+ years of Software Engineering experience, and 8 years as a Manager and Lead Engineer. I've climbed from Developer to Senior Developer, to Lead Developer, to Senior Engineering Manager leading a world-wide remote team of twelve.

Today with Claude Code, I build AI-powered software at Olio Apps as a Lead Software Engineer in Portland, OR. I ship BlackLine's new AI Account Recs 3.0 product, and the Daily Reading app for the Grace and Mercy Foundation.

The best way to get to know me better is through my professional website: <https://phils.app>

### Employment History

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#### Lead Software Engineer at Olio Apps, Portland, OR

May 2025 – Present

- I build full-stack software for clients big and small, side-by-side with the people who use it, from the first sketch through launch day.
- Building **BlackLine's AI Account Recs 3.0** product for financial account reconciliation with **Python** and **Google's Agent Development Kit (ADK)**.
- Native web/iOS/Android **Daily Reading** app for the **Grace and Mercy Foundation**, like the Kindle app, but fancier.
- Own client relationships, sprint planning, and delivery across multiple concurrent projects.

#### Watts Syncta, Portland, OR

July 2018 – April 2025

Syncta provides mobile software for backflow testers and water purveyors.

##### Senior Software Engineering Manager · June 2019 – April 2025

- Hired 12 software engineers and built the development team from the ground up, planned their career advancement, and roadmapped our projects.
- Built our Ruby on Rails & React webapps, our iOS and Android mobile apps, our APIs, and payments processing.
- Brought our AWS infrastructure up to SOC 2 security compliance with Vanta.

##### Lead Software Engineer · July 2018 – May 2019

- I took charge of our Ruby on Rails app and the JSON API that powered our iOS and Android apps.
- Built the technology powering SynctaOne and internal tools like our AutoPhil Chrome extension (named after me!).
- Served as the hands-on technical lead across every app.

#### Merit (readMedia / readabout.me), New York, NY

2008 – 2016

##### Senior Software Engineer, Ruby on Rails · 2014 – 2016

##### Software Engineer · 2008 – 2014

- Merit showcases student achievements at hundreds of colleges and universities. Meritpages.com is the largest Rails app I've ever worked on, comprising eight Rails apps deployed in a services architecture on an AWS Ubuntu Linux cluster.
- I joined readMedia in 2008 as one of three developers, upgraded the Ruby on Rails app from version 2 to version 3, and helped move it onto AWS, modernizing a legacy production system without pausing delivery.
- The company pivoted through readabout.me, where we outgrew Heroku and switched to AWS, on its way to becoming Merit.

## Skills

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**Leadership:** Leadership & management · hiring & growth · mentoring · mentor & career development · staff engineer · technical lead · pairing & debugging · code review · Agile w/ Jira · remote team building

**Technical:** AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Copilot, Google Agent Development Kit (ADK), LLM integration, prompt engineering) · Python · TypeScript · React.js & Next.js · Node.js · Ruby on Rails · GraphQL/REST APIs · frontend & backend · PostgreSQL & MySQL · NoSQL · Firebase · Amazon AWS · Docker · DevOps & CI/CD · testing & test coverage · observability · deployment & maintainability · documentation · Linux & bash · git · Security w/ SOC 2

## Hobbies

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Poker (\$77,000 in live tournament winnings), Mediterranean food, Chess, Sailing, Guitar, and my dog Sophie!

## Education

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### **Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Mathematics at Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA**

2001 – 2005

I have two publications: “Reflections in a Euclidean Space”, and “Exploration of Reflection Holograms and Their Fringes With a Scanning Electron Microscope”.

### **Master of Arts (M.A.) in Math Education at New York University, New York, NY**

2005 – 2006

I attended NYU through Math for America where I took my theoretical knowledge of mathematics and added practical knowledge of teaching.

## References

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Scott Becker, CEO of Olio Apps · Diana Lefavi, Director from Watts · Jeremiah Church, Founder from Syncta · Jason Fox, CTO from Merit · Colin Mathews, CEO from Merit

*Contact info available on request.*